

THE UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE

1998-06-01

1 dear bahá'í friends,

recently a number of questions have been raised regarding the deputi-

2 zation of institute teachers and coordinators, and the universal house of

3 justice has instructed us to bring to your attention the passage below from

4 its riḡván 1996 message and to comment on it as follows.

“center your energies in the propagation of the faith of god,”

bahá'u'lláh thus instructs his servants, adding, “ whoso is worthy of

5 so high a calling, let him arise and promote it. whoso is unable, it is

his duty to appoint him who will, in his stead, proclaim this revela-

6 tion. . . .” just as one deputizes another to teach in one's stead by cov-

7 ering the expenses of a pioneer or traveling teacher, one can deputize a

8 teacher serving an institute, who is, of course, a teacher of teachers. To

9 do so, one may make contributions to the continental bahá'í fund,

as well as to the local, National and international funds, earmarked

for this purpose.270-1

10 referring to this passage in its letter of 6 August 1996,270-2 the house of

11 justice informed the bahá'í world of its decision to contribute uS\$300,000

12 for the deputization of institute teachers, to be divided among the five con-

13 tinental funds, and expressed the hope that the friends, especially those

14 with means, would follow suit and would give adequate attention to this area of
urgent need. in that letter, it was indicated that the counselors

15 would be asked to keep their Auxiliary board members apprised of the level

16 of deputization required by institutes in various regions so that they could make this
information available to those who wished to pursue this new possibility.

17 270-1. See no. 216, pp. 480–95.

18 270-2. See no. 231, pp. 546–47 .270.1

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271 1996–2000 • T h e f o u r Y e a r P l a n

272 625clearly, the individual believer has a number of options available to him
273 or her in complying with bahá'u'lláh's injunction. funds can be given di-
274 rectly to a specific believer who has been selected to act as one's deputy or
275 can be contributed to one of the various funds of the faith, as mentioned
276 above. however, for the deputization of institute teachers, the house of
277 justice wished to ensure that contributions and needs would be matched in
278 such a way that national communities whose resources are meager would benefit
from the assistance of those in communities with more resources at their disposal, whether in
the same continent or another. Since the conti-

279 nental boards of counselors are in the best position to know the needs of
280 institutes in various regions, it was felt that contributing to the continental
281 fund is an efficient way for an individual believer to perform this service.

with this in mind, the house of justice requested the international

Teaching center to compile and organize the necessary information and

282 to share it with all counselors. Accordingly, the Teaching center identified
283 three figures around which the deputization needs worldwide seemed to be
clustered: uS\$1,200, uS\$3,600 and uS\$7,200 per staff member per year.

284 it also drew up a list of countries, in groups by continent, where institute
285 teachers and coordinators could benefit from deputization. it was suggested
286 to the counselors that they provide this list and the figures to the Auxiliary
287 board members to use in their consultations with those wishing to sup-
288 port one or more staff members of an institute for a given period of time,
289 allowing the friends to choose the region to which their funds should be channelled.
The T rustees of the continental funds were asked to see to

290 it is envisioned that the Teaching center will bring the list of countries up
291 to date from time to time and revise the figures as necessary.

292 while the Auxiliary board members are not being asked to solicit funds,

293 they are expected to go beyond the general promotion of deputization among the
believers and to discuss the specific details with them when it is appropri-ate to do so. The
arrangements needed to ensure that the contributions reach

294 the proper continental funds vary from country to country. Therefore, you
295 may wish to consult with the counselors to determine what measures can be
296 taken to advance this important endeavor in your community.

297 with loving b ahá'í greetings,

for Department of tHe secretariat270.3

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Passing of Peter Vuyiya, Former Counselor

Member of the International Teaching Center

[signed: The Universal House of Justice]